

× LOCAL EFFORT WALKER

Midwest-centered food cooperative
for a local cultural institution.

MAY 2026
PREPARED FOR WALKER ART CENTER

STATEMENT

Exhibiting and celebrating Minnesotan excellence for a global audience.

Hospitality at Walker Art Center should center Midwestern people, and Midwestern ingredients, for regional and international audiences, for patrons and visitors, for kids and for grownups, for families and for students. Local Effort proposes an obsessively local restaurant at Walker Art Center.

Local Effort represents local interests through highly curated ingredient selection, culinary and service excellence, and socially progressive labor practice. A collaboration with Local Effort is a commitment to Midwestern values.

From casual to refined formats,
a local-first commitment.



PLATE Nº 01
CHERRY PIE

THE OPPORTUNITY

Our collaboration brings local ingredients to every visitor experience.

I.

Year-round, world-class greenmarket sets the vibe during the day. Peak-harvest seasonal produce all summer. Get a locally-grown greenhouse cucumber in January.

III.

Genre-defining meal prep subscription program to feed families all week. Filling a huge gap and growing demand in our community, and celebrating home cooks and Midwestern home cooking.

V.

Tiered pricing for the public, memberships, Walker staff discounts. Meeting communities where they are at.

II.

Casual breakfast and lunch, with substantial grab-and-go options, for every type of diner. Refined, elevated dinner experiences with classic table service to show off our local culinary prowess.

IV.

Robust on-site events capacity and vision. Supporting Walker's event needs, and showcasing Midwestern hospitality with style and substance.

VI.

Ownership opportunity extended to all staff: committed to the 308b Cooperative structure. Real equity and profitshare.

SERVICE CONTINUUM

Different forms of hospitality, the same local ingredients.

I.

Breakfast, Bakery & Morning Drinks

Coffee, tea, shakes. Yogurt and granola. Cottage cheese. Cranberry bars. Everyday entry point – accessible to every visitor.

II.

Grab-and-go & Walk-in Lunch

Counter service with seating. Bowls, salads, sandwiches, rotisserie chicken, breads and dips, charcuterie and cheese, picnic baskets and boxed lunches. Farmers market weekly with fresh produce and dairy daily.

III.

Weekly Meal Prep

Derived from the farmer's market week to week. Breakfast, lunch, and dinner prepared and delivered to members weekly. Nutritionally focused comfort foods. Offered as grab and go.

IV.

Local Pizza

Flagship product, touching every menu. Hot and fresh, or take a frozen one home for later.

V.

Dinner

Elegant, humble Minnesotan farm-to-table, individual plates and shared platters. Classic dinner service with high personal touch, including host, reservations, walk-ins, bar seating, servers, wine, cocktails, NA beverages, locally produced dishware. Great for families, for dates, for international guests.

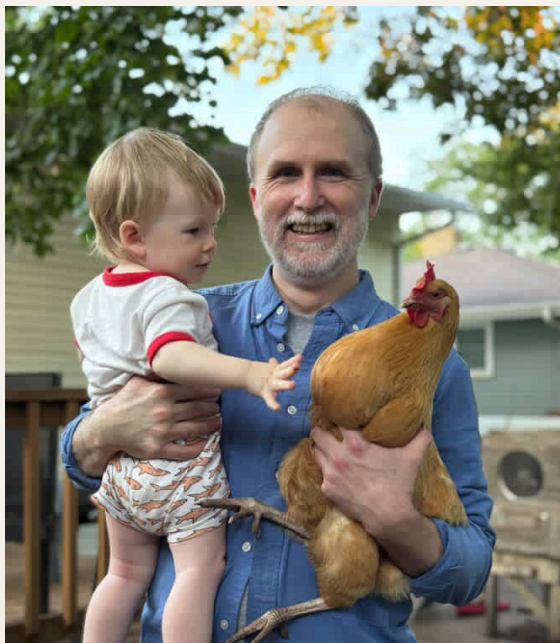
VI.

Chef Menus & Patron Events

Tied to exhibitions, artists, cinema, theater, and other VIP moments: supporting Walker's event needs.

TEAM

Day One Leadership.



Weston Smith

CO-FOUNDER • CHEF

California born, New York trained. 308b organizer, ingredient specialist. Weston makes bread and chocolate, oversees the Effort, and guarantees quality.



Catherine Olsen

CO-FOUNDER • KITCHEN MANAGER • PASTRY

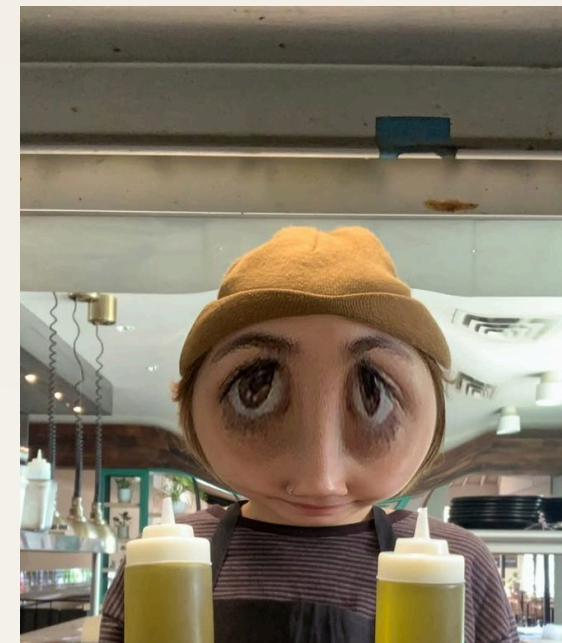
Minneapolis born and raised. Many recognize her from Lucia's and Wuollet Bakery, or the Eastside Coop. Vibe setter, cake and pastry provider.



Alyssa Andes

EVENT DIRECTOR • COMMUNICATIONS

Best-in-class event coordinator, and a huge asset to our business and community. Check out Soup Sisters.



Maria Beck

CHEF • PASTRY

Maria ran pastry at Lynette, many know her from Hyacinth, and she comes fresh off the Cardamom project. She's bringing effortless professionalism and good taste, besides being a bakery crusher.

FOOD & BEVERAGE COMMUNITY

Backed by the best.



308(B) COOPERATIVE STRUCTURE

Organization & Operations

worker-owned and managed

308(B) DISTINCTION

Only *internal equity holders* – those working directly on the project – hold governance. External members observe and speak but *do not vote*.

The Board

POLICY · CAPITAL
DECISIONS

FOUNDERS

Founding Members

Full governance & voting rights

ELECTED

Staff Reps

Elected by staff-owners; full voting rights

INVESTORS

Capital Partners

Observation & speaking rights; no vote

OBSERVERS

Community & Customer Members

Speaking & observation rights; no vote

Management

OPERATIONS ·
INTERNAL GOVERNANCE ·
DAY-TO-DAY SPENDING

KITCHEN

Executive Chef

Menu, sourcing, hiring; all food decisions

FRONT OF HOUSE

General Manager

Greenmarket & service operations

PROGRAMMING

Events Director

On-site events & Walker partnership

COOPERATIVE

308(b) Director

Cooperative governance, compliance, equity admin

Management

DEPARTMENT LEADS ·
EQUITY OWNERS

← EXEC CHEF

Sous Chefs

Meal prep program, bakery, daily production

← GM

Service Managers & Maître d'

Dinner & daytime department leads

← 308(B) DIRECTOR

HR & Staff Admin

People ops, cooperative specialist

↑ STAFF ELECTS REPRESENTATIVES TO THE BOARD

Staff

EQUITY OWNERSHIP
AVAILABLE TO ALL STAFF

KITCHEN

Cooks

Line cooks, meal prep, bread/bakery

SERVICE

Counter Service

Baristas, bartenders, sales

SERVICE

Floor Service

Servers, food runners, hosts

FULL GOVERNANCE – VOTING RIGHTS OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP – EQUITY OWNERS STAFF-OWNERS – INTERNAL GOVERNANCE RIGHTS OBSERVERS – NO VOTING RIGHTS

We work *for the food.*



MORNING & AFTERNOON



MORNING

Coffee

tea, juice, chocolate milk, nutritional shakes

Pastries and Breads

Cinnamon Roll
Biali, Romano and Hazelnut
Popover, Gruyere and Ham
Cherry Hand Tart
Rugbrod
Dinner rolls

Duck Egg Sandwich

Duck egg, duck bacon or sausage, colby cheese,
tomato jam on english muffin.

Yogurt & Granola

Fresh yogurt made daily, local dairy, house-made
chocolate granola, seasonal fruit.

Shakshuka

Eggs, tomato, bellpepper, served with flatbread.

GRAB & GO

Picnics & Boxed Lunches

Sandwiches, salads, charcuterie and cheese.

Farmers Market Selections

Peak produce, dairy, cheese.

Meal Prep Selections

Low-cost meals for later.

Rotisserie Chicken

Pastured, herb-seasoned, available from noon.
Optional with rice or potatoes.

LUNCH

COUNTER SERVICE

Salads & Grain Bowls

Market-driven, built to order. Grains, legumes, seasonal vegetables.

Local Pizza

100% midwest ingredients. Sourdough crusts. Multiple pepperonis.

Med Spread

Fresh cultured labneh, hummus, pita, tomatoes, cucumbers, peas. Add roasted chicken or lamb.



PRODUCT EXPRESSION

LOCAL PIZZA

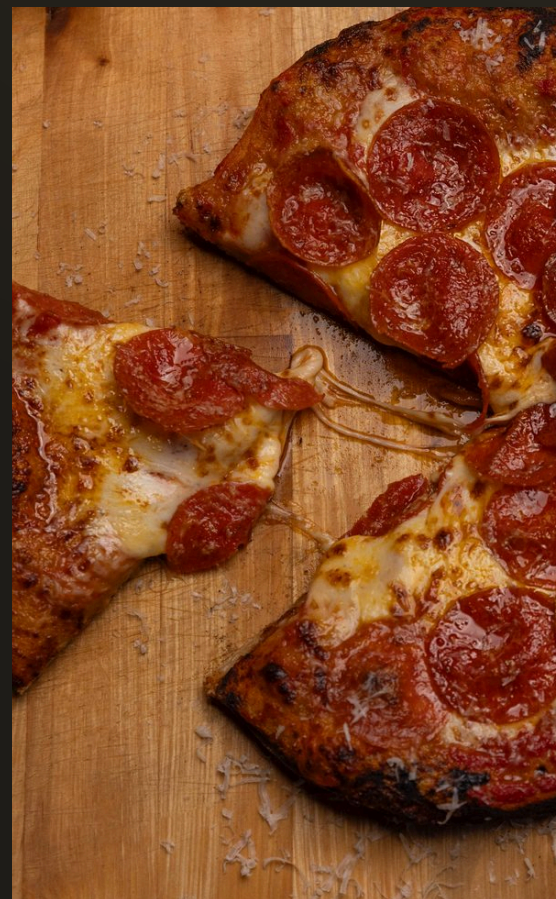
Sourdough crusts from freshly milled local grain. Mozzarella and brick cheese from Wisconsin dairy. Tomatoes from our markets, or our backyards, or Dei Fretelli from Ohio. Classic and seasonal toppings, just have a good time.

Local Pizza is an accessible, popular expression of our local-first mentality. We bring this local touch to every menu, every meal, every dish, every visitor.



LUNCH

slices, whole pies, slice + salad



DINNER

pizza beside seasonal plates and bar food



EVENTS

pizza boards, patio gatherings, late-service food

MEAL PREP

frozen or par-baked take-home formats

DINNER



PLATES

Beets over Labneh

roasted and smoked, dressed in citrus, sumac and hazelnut over fresh labneh

Local Pizza

Wisconsin mozzarella and brick, market tomatoes, durum and red fife, seasonal toppings.

Carrots Walker

carrot juice, orange juice, junmai vinegar glaze slow roasted carrots.

Duck Pastrami

pickles and bread

Loaded Sweet Potato

purple or white sweet potato, guanciale, pecorino

CHEF MENUS

FORMATS

Exhibition Dinner

Menu tied to current exhibition – ingredient, region, or artist concept.

Artist & Filmmaker Dinner

Hosted meal during residencies, openings, or screenings.

Member & Donor Evening

Seasonal multi-course format for patrons and supporters.

Patio Evening

Casual outdoor service, pizza and plates, late spring through fall.

Program Tie-In

Food paired with cinema, theater, lecture, or performance schedule.



WEEKLY MEAL PREP

Feeding families local meals all week.



Weekly meal prep turns the same sourcing and prep base into home meals for families. Weekly delivery, flexible pricing, low-brow and high nutrition.

– it's a subscription to local cooking.